

Tai Motion

TAI CHI · GUIDE SERIES

Joint & Mobility

A gentle, seated routine to help your joints feel looser, move more easily, and stay comfortable — a few minutes a day, right from your chair.

Suitable for every level · No equipment needed

Welcome to your Joint & Mobility guide

Stiff, achy joints can make everyday movements — reaching a shelf, getting out of a chair, turning to look behind you — feel harder than they should. The good news: gentle, regular movement is one of the kindest things you can do for them.

Our joints love to move. Easy, mindful motion helps keep them lubricated, encourages a comfortable range of movement, and supports the muscles around them. You don't need to stretch hard or push through pain — in fact, the opposite is true. Slow and gentle wins.

This guide gives you a simple set of seated movements you can do in a sturdy chair, in any order, at your own pace. Do a few, or do them all — what matters most is showing up gently and often.

Before you begin — a quick safety note. Move slowly and only within a range that feels comfortable. Never force a movement or push into sharp pain. If you have a joint condition, a recent injury or surgery, or any concern, check with your doctor or physical therapist before starting. Stop and rest if you feel dizzy or unwell.

How to use this guide

Set up. Sit tall in a sturdy, non-wheeled chair with both feet flat on the floor, toward the front of the seat so you can move freely.

Breathe & go slowly. Keep your breath easy; breathe out as you move into a stretch, in as you return. Each movement should feel smooth — gentle ease, never strain.

Little and often. Just 8–10 minutes a day is plenty to start. On the pages that follow, each exercise has a numbered photo strip — simply follow the steps 1, 2, 3.

Slow Neck Turns

Good for neck comfort and looking over your shoulder.



1. Sit tall, chin level, shoulders relaxed.
2. Slowly turn your head to look over your right shoulder, as far as is comfortable.
3. Pause for one breath, then return to center. Repeat to the left.

Do: 4-5 turns each side, slowly.

Keep the movement smooth — imagine your head floating on your spine.

Shoulder Rolls

Good for releasing upper-back and shoulder tension.



1. Let your arms rest by your sides.
2. Lift both shoulders up toward your ears, roll them back, then down.
3. Make big, slow circles.

Do: 5 rolls backward, then 5 forward.

Sighing out as your shoulders drop helps the tension melt away.

Shoulder-Blade Squeeze

Good for posture and upper-back strength.



1. Sit tall with your arms relaxed.
2. Gently draw your shoulder blades toward each other, opening across the chest.
3. Hold for 2-3 seconds, then release.

Do: 6-8 gentle squeezes.

Think “proud chest,” not “clenched” — light effort is enough.

Wrist Circles

Good for wrist mobility and everyday grip.



1. Hold both arms out in front, hands in loose fists.
2. Circle your wrists slowly in one direction, then the other.

Do: 6 circles each direction.

Great to do any time — while the kettle boils or an advert plays.

Fist & Fan

Good for finger flexibility and hand comfort.



1. Make a soft fist with both hands.
2. Open and spread your fingers wide, like a fan.
3. Close them again slowly.

Do: 8-10 slow open-and-close.

Helpful for hands that feel stiff first thing in the morning.

Elbow Bends

Good for elbow range and arm ease.



1. Let your arms hang by your sides.
2. Slowly bend both elbows, bringing your hands toward your shoulders.
3. Lower them back down with control.

Do: 8 slow bends.

No weights needed — the gentle motion is the point.

Seated Cat-Cow

Good for a supple, comfortable spine.



1. Rest your hands on your knees.
2. Breathe in and gently arch — chest forward, look slightly up.
3. Breathe out and round — tuck your chin, curve your back like a “C.”

Do: 5-6 slow rounds, following your breath.

Keep it small and gentle; let your breath lead the movement.

Gentle Seated Twist

Good for mid-back mobility and turning ease.



1. Sit tall, feet flat.
2. Place your right hand on your left knee and turn gently to the left.
3. Look over your shoulder only as far as feels easy. Return, then switch sides.

Do: 3-4 twists each side, holding one breath.

Lengthen up tall first, then turn — never wrench or force it.

Side Reach

Good for opening the sides and ribs.



1. Rest your left hand on the chair.
2. Float your right arm up and lean gently to the left, feeling a soft stretch along your right side.
3. Return to center, then switch sides.

Do: 3 reaches each side.

A little lean goes a long way — comfort over depth.

Seated Marching

Good for hip mobility and circulation.



1. Sit tall, holding the sides of the chair if you like.
2. Slowly lift one knee, lower it, then lift the other — like a gentle march.

Do: 10 lifts total (5 each side).

Keep it slow and steady rather than fast.

Knee Extensions

Good for knee comfort and leg strength.



1. Sit tall with your feet flat.
2. Straighten one leg out in front, hold for 2 seconds, then lower slowly.
3. Switch legs.

Do: 6-8 each leg.

Point and flex your foot at the top for a little extra ankle movement.

Ankle Circles & Heel-Toe

Good for ankle mobility and steadiness on your feet.



1. Lift one foot slightly and circle the ankle slowly, both directions.
2. Lower it, then gently rock heel-to-toe a few times. Switch feet.

Do: 5 circles each way, then 6 heel-toe rocks per foot.

Supple ankles help with balance and confident walking.

Your 8-minute daily flow

Short on time? Move through these in order for a gentle top-to-toe joint wake-up.

1. Shoulder Rolls — 5 each way
2. Slow Neck Turns — 4 each side
3. Wrist Circles + Fist & Fan — 6 each
4. Seated Cat-Cow — 5 rounds
5. Gentle Seated Twist — 3 each side
6. Side Reach — 3 each side
7. Seated Marching — 10 lifts
8. Knee Extensions — 6 each leg
9. Ankle Circles & Heel-Toe — to finish

Finish with one slow breath. Sit tall, breathe in through your nose, and sigh it out. Notice how your body feels a little looser than when you started.

Making it a gentle habit

Anchor it to something you already do

Pair your routine with a daily moment — your morning tea, a favourite programme, or just before lunch. Attaching it to an existing habit makes it far easier to stick with.

Off days are completely okay

Missed a day? No guilt — simply pick it up again tomorrow. Progress comes from returning gently, not from being perfect.

When to check with your doctor. Please speak with a healthcare professional before continuing if you notice new or worsening joint pain, swelling, redness or warmth around a joint, numbness or tingling, or any pain that doesn't settle with

rest. These movements are meant to feel comfortable — your body's comfort is always the guide.

This guide is part of the Tai Motion Tai Chi Guide Series. It offers general wellness and movement suggestions only and is not medical advice. It is not intended to diagnose, treat, cure, or prevent any condition. Always talk to a qualified healthcare professional before beginning a new activity, especially if you have a medical condition, injury, or concern. © Tai Motion.